

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Buying or Licensing an IT Solution



Learning Outcome:

Understand information about people's backgrounds in spoken or written documents.

Participate in the improvement of IT contracts, establishing technical clauses that respond to the needs of the negotiating agents, based on current laws on contracting.

Ask your partner:

- Which do you think is best buying or licensing an IT solution? Why?
- Is it important to test recently acquired IT solution before making a payment? Why?

Can Do Statements:

- I can discuss whether an organization needs to buy or license an IT solution.
- I can discuss the importance of making payments only when the solution proves to be effective.
- I can talk about the importance of carrying out acceptance tests on the company's own.





Let's Explore!

Sarah and Charles are discussing about contracting tips.



Instructions: Read the text below.

Charles: Hey, Sarah. May I ask you some questions about the internship you did at the IT department in TRG Accounting?

Sarah: Sure! Go ahead.

Charles: What determines whether an organization needs to buy or license an IT solution?

Sarah: Well, that's a question they asked themselves when I was at TRG. I guess every organization needs to choose whether they want to have their own customized software, or if a license would do the job. So, it is necessary for an organization to assess which IT product best fits their needs. But what it's most important is the ownership rights.

Charles: How's that?

Sarah: I mean, even if they buy their own IT solution, the developer would own the software. That means that the organization would only have licensed rights, unless it is specified otherwise in the contract agreement. That scenario might lead to additional fees, and no organization would ever want that.

Charles: I see your point. Now, what about the payments? I mean, when buying IT products, is the contract price paid up front?

Sarah: Not quite. It is true, though, that vendors often ask a big percentage of the contract price, but TRG would only pay under the acceptance of deliverables and services. This means that they can put off paying the vendors until the organization is sure that the procured products meet requirements and expectations.

Charles: How do they make sure the products work just fine?

Sarah: Well, in IT systems negotiations there's something called acceptance tests, which involve putting new systems to test. These tests should be performed by the company or by an external consultant to ensure objectivity. Depending on the results of these tests, the organization will determine to accept and pay for the installed system.



Let's Practice!

Charles explains the differences between* buying and licensing.

* "Between" is used when something or somebody is located in the middle of two objects.

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

keeping the license? / the contract agreement / for the installed system /
giving the advantages / consider accepting the terms.

1. He avoided signing _____.
2. Not quite. You have to _____.
3. I mean, they can finish _____.
4. Do you know if you risk _____
5. It involves accepting and paying _____.



Let's Practice!

How important are Acceptance Tests to check systems?

Instructions: Match column A with Column B.

COLUMN A

1. Every organization needs...
2. Tests are used to...
3. Some companies decide to have their systems...
4. Depending on the results of these tests, the company...
5. Also, the companies choose to pay for the...
6. When companies want to make sure...

COLUMN B

- a. ...systems after the results of the tests.
- b. ...to put new systems to test.
- c. ...their products work fine, they carry out acceptance tests.
- d. ...determines to accept the installed system.
- e. ...ensure objectivity of the systems.
- f. ...tested by external consultants.



Extension Activity

We talked about IT services. Now let's do some research on how it is in your community.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Search on the internet how companies acquire IT services and how often they do it.
- Write a list of aspects companies take into account before getting IT services.
- Write a letter to a company suggesting those aspects.
- Share your letter with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I search information about IT services acquisition in my community. ☐ Yes ☐ No
- I make a list using vocabulary and structures on IT services. ☐ Yes ☐ No
- I write a letter suggesting important aspects. ☐ Yes ☐ No
- I discuss with a partner about the differences in our lists. ☐ Yes ☐ No



Target Words

- put off** (phrasal verb): to delay or postpone.
e.g. This means that they can put off paying the vendors until the organization is sure that the procured products meet requirements and expectations.
- not quite** (expression): not exactly.
e.g. Charles: I mean, when buying IT products, is the contract price paid up front?
Sarah: Not quite.
- agreement** (noun): the arrangement both parties related to a course of action.
e.g. That means that the organization would only have licensed rights, unless it is specified otherwise in the contract agreement.
- internship** (noun): a period of time in which a person gets practical experience in a profession or occupation.
e.g. May I ask you some questions about the internship you did at the IT department in TRG Accounting?
- do the job** (expression): to achieve the expected result.
e.g. I guess every organization needs to choose whether they want to have their own customized software, or if a license would do the job.
- ownership** (noun): legal statement of possession.
e.g. But what it's most important is the ownership rights.



Learning Points

Verb + ing and to + verb, to talk about Purchasing or Licensing IT Systems

Some verbs are followed specifically by -ing or infinitive forms of the verbs. Below, you can find some common verbs that are followed by -ing forms:

• Avoid • Put off • Risk • Involve	-ing
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Example:

*It is necessary to **put off paying** licensing fees if the IT solution doesn't meet the company's needs.*

The following is a list of common verbs that are followed by the infinite form of the verb:

• Decide • Need • Choose • Determine • Want	to verb
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Example:

*A company **needs to assess** their IT needs.*

Examples

What determines whether an organization needs to buy or license an IT solution? Well, in IT systems negotiations there's something called acceptance tests, which involve putting new systems to test.

Depending on the results of these tests, they organization will determine to accept and pay for the installed system.

Benefits for successful implementation of an information technology system.

In spite of the common risks and limitations when implementing an information technology solution, there are extraordinary benefits for any operation or project such as:

- Easier access to organizational data
- Management of access security levels
- Error reduction
- Faster response time
- Cost savings
- Greater security
- Improved productivity

